

Geography





About the Course

Students learn current and historical aspects of regional and world geography with map work.



Placement & Combining Tips

Also suitable for students in Grades 10-12.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
9	Geography: Grade 9 2 times/week 30 min	Prisoners of Geography: Ten Maps That Explain Everything About the World Five Months on the Missouri River: Paddling a Dugout Canoe Prisoners of Geography: Our World Explained in 12 Simple Maps

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Geography: Grade 9				
	Geography: Grade 9		Geography: Grade 9	



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Geography: Grade 9

☐ Links to blank outline maps are in the Lesson Plans. Maps in the books for the course can be used as well.

☐ You will need a blank or dotted notebook or sketchbook for your map work.

☐ Make a point to know something about places mentioned in current news and events of the day. Look up place names in your atlas. Perhaps make a map to identify event locations throughout the year.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Geography: Grade 9



Prisoners of Geography: Ten Maps That Explain Everything About the World



Five Months on the Missouri River: Paddling a Dugout Canoe



Prisoners of Geography: Our World Explained in 12 Simple Maps



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Geography: Grade 9

∞ [Extra Helpings](#)

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 16: Geography\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



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How To Approach



Recap

- Take a second to recall what you read previously in the same book or topic. This is not necessarily a full narration, but rather a recall of the main points and any interesting ideas.
- If the last passage is difficult to remember, try looking back at the chapter title or a picture from within the chapter.



Map Work

- Each week, you will be looking at maps, constructing your own, locating places, and filling in the details of your map. Keep your map and atlas near you as you read.
- These lessons refer to a 'rough sketch' method that Charlotte Mason employed, in which the rough shape of the map is sketched through observation and then memory. The rough sketch is not intended to be precise or detailed. Examples are linked to the first lesson.
- If an alternative to a physical sketch is needed, you may trace or use the mental sketching described in the first lesson throughout the course. You may also experiment with different methods for interest or to see which method helps you best.
- One way to personalize interest and challenge in this course is to adjust the amount and type of locations included in Mapwork. If the number of locations listed is too numerous for you to think about and remember, then map fewer, choosing locations that seem interesting and relevant to the point of the book. If the number of locations listed leaves you wanting more, then add more.



Read

- Read the selection assigned OR read for the number of minutes allocated, leaving time for narration and mapwork. Use whichever guide (i.e., pages or minutes) works best for you. You want to read enough to be interesting, but not so much that you feel overwhelmed.
- If a book is challenging for you as a student, try stopping to narrate to yourself silently for a minute every now and then to make sure you are tracking. You might also want to read aloud to yourself. Or you might want to listen to an audiobook version of the text and read along with it.
- If a book is an easy read, enjoy the ride!
- Keep an eye out for quotes to put in your commonplace book or events or characters to put down in your Book of Centuries.



Narrate

- You will narrate orally or silently to yourself using your map to help you connect what you are reading to your map, as well as to interact with and think about the ideas discussed in the chapter.
- For the book *All Over the Map*, you will come up with questions or comments about the maps you are looking at and reading about.



Memory Activity

- Periodically, you will practice sketching the maps that you have already worked on to help you remember and strengthen the mental map in your head of the various regions of the world. This will be very helpful when you are listening or reading about current events, as well as when

reading about various places in your other courses.

- If you are using the mental sketching method, then use a blank map for these activities.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. Accountability components are added to facilitate teacher/student discussion and growing independence.

It is also valuable for those in a classroom setting to have a mix of lessons that students complete themselves silently and others read aloud and narrate together. Geography lessons lend themselves well to a larger discussion time at the end of the lesson where student can share their maps and the ideas they found interesting.

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Term 1

WEEK 1 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 1

World Geography - Russia

 Materials: Prisoners of Geography

→ INTRO

To aid communication throughout this course, we will call the big blue Prisoners of Geography: Our World Explained in 12 Simple Maps book (optional) simply your "map book," and we will call Prisoners of Geography: Ten Maps That Explain Everything About the World your "Prisoners of Geography" book.

→ MAP WORK

Print one blank map of Russia.

∞ Map Link: Blank Map of Russia

Using the blank map as a pattern to trace or as a guide, sketch a rough map of Russia in your notebook. As in the sample sketch maps at the link, the basic shape is the objective rather than detailed perfection. If an alternative to sketching or tracing is needed, students may use their finger to trace the blank map. In this way, a blank map may be substituted for the sketch as needed throughout these lessons. Like imagining shapes in clouds, consider what the shape of the map looks like to help you remember your mental sketch.

∞ Image Link: Sketch maps

Using your atlas, globe, phone, and/or p.8-9 in your Prisoners of Geography book, locate the following items. Add to your map and label as many as you can reasonably recall:

•Moscow •St. Petersburg •Murmansk •Arctic Circle •Ural Mountains
•Lake Baikal •Siberia •Volga River •Crimea •Vladivostok •Anything else you would like

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently.

Prisoners of Geography p.1-9 (Introduction)

• STUDENT TIP

Make a point to know and look up something about places mentioned in the current news and events of the day. Look up place names in your atlas. Perhaps make a map to identify event locations throughout the year.

WEEK 1 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 2

Genesis of a Dream

 Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ INTRO

This book started from a series of weekly newspaper columns Elpel wrote as the expedition progressed in 2019. Travel along with Lewis and Clark, who first went up the river, and the modern crew as they explore down the Missouri River!

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 1 Genesis of a Dream

Narrate silently, which means to go over in your mind what you read. Or, if it is easier, talk quietly to yourself if your setting allows. You are narrating to yourself rather than writing or narrating orally. Start at the beginning and ask yourself what came next until you have gone over the chapter. It may seem strange at first, but you will quickly get used to it. This allows you time to do other things in the lesson, such as mapwork or reflection writing.

→ WRITE & DISCUSS (IF TIME AND SETTING ALLOW)

Compose 5 reflections about the chapter or choose from one of these questions:

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Term 1

- How do you think the act of making a tool by hand (like carving a canoe) changes your relationship to the journey it enables?
- Churchill Clark participated in building a canoe that echoed his ancestors' journey. What does it mean to carry family history in your hands literally? What do we owe to those who came before us? What skills, abilities, or knowledge do you have that has been handed down to you?

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Carving the Canoe

Watch what you have time for now and finish later if desired.

WEEK 2 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 3

World Geography - Russia Continued

📄 Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MAP WORK

Read p.8-11 in your map book (optional). Using your atlas, globe, phone, and/or your book, locate the following and add them to your map:

- Trans-Siberian Railway •Bering Sea •Arctic Ocean •Pacific Ocean
- Caspian Sea •Black Sea •Baltic Sea •Caucasus Mountains •North European Plain (p.9 in your map book) •Sevastopol •Anything else you would like

∞ Map Link: Blank Map of the World

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map as needed
Prisoners of Geography p.11-24 (first half of Russia)

★ STUDENT TIP

Remember to label what you want to recall.

WEEK 2 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 4

The Journey Begins

📄 Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 2 The Journey Begins
Narrate silently to yourself.

→ MAP WORK

Roughly copy by hand the map on p.12 into your notebook to orient you to the adventures ahead and to refer back to as you read. Sketch a series of more zoomed in maps as you travel down the river to add places, items of interest, or events that happen in each chapter.

→ RESEARCH

If you have time left in the lesson, research something interesting in the chapter that you want to know more about, such as wild foraging in your area or maybe Thomas P. Howard, a member of the original expedition. See the link below for information about Howard and to read more about the Lewis and Clark Expedition.

∞ Website Link: Thomas Howard

WEEK 3 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 5

World Geography - Russia Continued

📄 Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MEMORY SKETCH

Sketch a rough map of Russia and see what you can fill in without looking at your map. If you have been using blank maps, you may continue to do so, or you can try a rough sketch now!

• DISCUSS

If you are working independently, plan a time this week to go to your teacher, show them your map, and share something you are learning about this region of the world. If interested, you could create and share a travellog with illustrations or images that

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Term 1

→ MAP WORK

Read p.12-15 in your map book (optional). Locate/add to your map:

- Bering Strait •Add the border countries •Anything else you would like

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map

Prisoners of Geography p.25-37 (second half of Russia)

represent important ideas about the country or a travel poster created on Canva or another computer program. If working in a class, share with your classmates and teacher.

WEEK 3 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 6

Botanizing the River

 Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 3 Botanizing the River

Narrate silently to yourself.

→ WRITE

Discuss Elpel's quote on p.19, "We yearn to connect with nature, and not knowing how to do that, we treat nature as an adversary more than a dance partner. We pit human endurance against nature and seek to overcome her. We bask in the glory of our accomplishment while missing nearly everything along the way." How does developing a relationship with nature via nature study, nature walks, and nature journaling play into the discussion?

→ MAP WORK

Add places or items of interest to your map.

WEEK 4 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 7

World Geography - China

 Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MAP WORK

Print one blank map of China

∞ Map Link: Blank Map of China

Sketch a rough map of China in your notebook.

→ READ & MAP WORK

Read p.16-17 in your map book (optional). Using your atlas, globe, phone, and/or your book, locate/add to your map:

- Beijing •Japan •Taiwan •North Korea •South Korea •Shanghai •North China Plain •Yellow Sea •East China Sea •Manchuria •Mongolia
- Anything else you would like

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map

Prisoners of Geography p.40-52 (first half of China)

★ STUDENT TIP

You may continue mapping using the same method or try a new one! The purpose is to help you remember and think about the geography of the country.

WEEK 4 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 8

Wind Faeries

 Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 4 Wind Faeries

→ WRITE

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

The Missouri has been radically transformed — dammed, channelized, diked. Is this river still "the Missouri"? What makes a river a river?

→ MAP WORK

Add places or items of interest to your map.

WEEK 5 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 9

World Geography - China Continued

Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MAP WORK

Read p.18-23 in your map book (optional). Using your various sources, locate/add to your map:

•Tibet •Tibetan Plateau •Lhasa •Yellow River (p.20 in your map book)
•Mekong River •Yangtze River •Xinjiang •Urumqi •Hong Kong
•Himalayas •The Great Wall •Some surrounding countries •Anything else you would like

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map
Prisoners of Geography p.53-65 (second half of China)

★ STUDENT TIP

Remember to label what you reasonably want to recall.

Read the article below for additional information regarding the Uighurs and other minorities being taken advantage of in China.

∞ **Article Link:** Against Their Will: The Situation in Xinjiang

WEEK 5 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 10

Gates of the Prairie

Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 5 Gates of the Prairie

→ READ

∞ Article Link: Plant and Animal Discoveries
∞ Article Link: A Modern Lewis and Clark Survey
∞ Article Link: Lewis and Clark Expedition (scroll down for more of the quote that started the reading today)

→ WRITE

Discuss the Lewis quote or the two articles about wildlife discovery.

→ MAP WORK

Add places or items of interest to your map.

WEEK 6 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 11

World Geography - China Continued, US

Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MEMORY SKETCH

Sketch a rough map of China and see what you can fill in without looking at your map.

→ MAP WORK

Print one blank map of USA
∞ Map Link: Blank Map of USA

See how well you can sketch a map of the US without using the blank map. Then refine your sketch, if needed, using the map. Draw and label as many states as you can from memory, as well as rivers, mountains, and cities. Remember Alaska and Hawaii! Don't worry if you don't get the sizes or outlines right. It is a rough sketch.

★ STUDENT TIP

If time permits, watch two short videos that provide additional insight into how America expanded to the west coast.

∞ **Video Link:** 1800s U.S. History

∞ **Video Link:** John C. Fremont

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Term 1

→ READ

p.24-25 in your map book (optional). Use the map to fill in what you would like. We are going to skip p.26-29. Read on your own if interested.

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map
Prisoners of Geography p.68-79 (first half of US)

WEEK 6 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 12

Ghosts of the Tower

 Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 6 Ghosts of the Tower

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Montana (the first 8.5 minutes)

→ WRITE

Explain the Buffalo Jump.

→ MAP WORK

Add places or items of interest to your map.

WEEK 7 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 13

World Geography - Canada, US Continued

 Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MAP WORK

Print one blank map of Canada
∞ Map Link: Blank Map of Canada

See how well you can sketch a map of Canada without using the blank map you printed. Then refine your sketch if needed using the map. Draw and label as many provinces and territories as you can from memory, as well as rivers, mountains, and cities. Don't worry if you don't get the sizes or outline right. It is a rough sketch.

→ READ

p.30-33 in your map book (optional). Use the map of Canada to fill in what you would like.

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map
Prisoners of Geography p.80-89

★ STUDENT TIP

Read the short articles below for additional information regarding important events referenced in the reading.

∞ **Article Link:** Brexit: Meaning, Referendum, Date, and Consequences

∞ **Article Link:** Russian-Ukraine War: Map, Casualties, Timeline, Death Toll, Causes, & Significance

WEEK 7 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 14

A Hail of a Portage and Tools and Provisions

 Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapters 7 and 8 A Hail of a Portage and Tools and Provisions

→ READ

∞ Article Link: June 29, 1805

→ WRITE/DRAW/PAINT

Combine the 5 versions of the events of that day into one account, indicating what happened to each mentioned member of the expedition. Or draw/paint multiple scenes of that day's adventures for Lewis and

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Term 1

Clark and the others.

→ MAP WORK

Add places or items of interest to your map.

WEEK 8 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 15

World Geography - Western Europe

 Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MAP WORK

Print one blank map of Europe

∞ Map Link: Blank Map of Europe

Sketch a rough map of Europe.

→ READ & NARRATE

p.34-37 in your map book (optional)

Using your various sources, locate/add to your map:

●France ●Pyrenees ●Spain ●Portugal ●Alps ●Rhine River ●Germany
●Slovakia ●Hungary ●Croatia ●Serbia ●Romania ●Bulgaria ●Italy ●Greece
●Turkey ●Poland ●Anything else you would like

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map

Prisoners of Geography p.90-102 (first half of Western Europe)

WEEK 8 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 16

Decisions of Leadership

 Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 9 Decisions of Leadership

→ WRITE

After hearing about how Lewis and Clark and Elpel choose their group members, how would you choose a group to go with you on an epic adventure through the wilderness?

→ MAP WORK

Add places or items of interest to your map.

WEEK 9 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 17

World Geography - Western Europe Continued

 Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MAP WORK

Read p.38-41 in your map book. Using your various sources, locate/add to your map:

●Sweden ●Denmark ●Norway ●Finland ●Albania ●Slovenia ●United Kingdom ●The GIUK Gap ●Carpathian Mountains ●English Channel
●North Sea ●Mediterranean Sea ●Anything else you would like

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map

Prisoners of Geography p.103-113 (second half of Western Europe)

★ STUDENT TIP

Explore the Easy to read - about the Eu | European Union article to better understand the European Union.

∞ Article Link: Easy to read - about the Eu | European Union

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Term 1

WEEK 9 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 18

Visionary Enchantment

Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 10 Visionary Enchantment

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Upper Missouri River Breaks

→ WRITE

Try writing a poem capturing the beauty of the land paddled through in this reading.

→ MAP WORK

Add places or items of interest to your map.

WEEK 10 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 19

World Geography

Catch-Up Week

→ CATCH UP

Finish any reading and map-making if needed.

→ MAP WORK

Practice drawing sketch maps of Russia, China, the US, Canada, and Europe. Add as many items as you can remember. Look at your originals and see how you did. Add other items to your maps if you wish.

• DISCUSS

If you are working independently, plan a time this week to go to your teacher, show them one of your maps, and share something you are learning about a region of the world. If interested, you could create and share a travelog with illustrations or images that represent important ideas about the country or a travel poster created on Canva or another computer program. If working in a class, share with your classmates and teacher.

WEEK 10 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 20

Crossroads in History

Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 11 Crossroads in History

→ READ

∞ Article Link: A Gallery of Concretions

∞ Article Link: What is a Coulee?

→ WRITE

Write about concretions, coulees, or something else in the reading that interested you.

→ MAP WORK

Add places or items of interest to your map.

WEEK 11 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 21

World Geography

Catch-Up Week

→ CATCH UP

Finish any reading and map-making if needed.

→ MAP WORK

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Term 1

Practice drawing sketch maps of Russia, China, the US, Canada, and Europe. Add as many items as you can remember. Look at your originals and see how you did. Add other items to your maps if you wish.	
WEEK 11 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 22 Roaming and Rambling Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook → READ & NARRATE Chapter 12 Roaming and Rambling → WRITE Elpel states, "Freedom to roam is critical to inspire a new generation of thinkers, doers, and leaders." What do you think about that? → MAP WORK Add places or items of interest to your map.	
WEEK 12 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 23 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Prisoners of Geography	
WEEK 12 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 24 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Five Months on the Missouri River	

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Term 2

WEEK 1 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 25

World Geography - Africa

Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MAP WORK

Print one blank map of Africa

∞ Map Link: Blank Map of Africa

Sketch a rough map of Africa using the blank map or p.115 in your Prisoners of Geography book.

→ READ

p.42-43 in your map book (optional). Locate/add to your map:

●Sahara Desert ●Indian Ocean ●Red Sea ●Mediterranean Sea ●Atlantic Ocean ●Cape of Good Hope ●Suez Canal ●Sahel ●Gambia ●Niger ●Chad ●Eritrea ●Congo ●Central African Republic ●Uganda ●Tanzania ●Angola ●Namibia ●Zambezi River ●Victoria Falls ●Anything else you would like

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map. Stop after reading p.117 and look at the link on map distortion before finishing the reading.

Prisoners of Geography p.115-123 (first part of Africa)

∞ Article Link: Maps Distort How We See the World

★ STUDENT TIP

You may continue mapping using the same method or try a new one! The purpose is to help you remember and think about the geography of the country.

WEEK 1 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 26

Swiss Cheese and Bison

Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 13 Swiss Cheese and Bison

→ WRITE

Write a paragraph in support of the ranchers and another in support of the American Prairie Reserve.

→ MAP WORK

Add places or items of interest to your map.

WEEK 2 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 27

World Geography - Africa Continued

Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MAP WORK

Read p.44-45 in your map book (optional). Using your various sources, locate/add to your map:

●Mozambique ●Congo River ●Niger River ●Zimbabwe ●Sudan ●Somalia ●Kenya ●Angola ●Democratic Republic of the Congo ●Nigeria ●Mali ●Libya ●Uganda ●Rwanda ●Burundi ●Ethiopia ●Egypt ●Blue Nile ●White Nile ●Djibouti ●Anything else you would like

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map.

Prisoners of Geography p.124-131 (second part of Africa)

★ STUDENT TIP

Remember to label what you reasonably want to recall.

Read the article below to better understand the Democratic Republic of the Congo

∞ Article Link: Democratic Republic of the Congo - Colonialism, Civil War, Conflict

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 2 ☐ 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 28

The Lakeness Monster

☐ Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 14 The Lakeness Monster

→ WRITE

The dams transformed this section of the wild Missouri into a series of lakes. What is lost when a river is tamed? What is gained?

→ MAP WORK

Add places or items of interest to your map.

WEEK 3 ☐ 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 29

World Geography - Africa Continued

☐ Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MAP WORK

Read p.46-49 in your map book (optional). Locate/add to your map:

●Cameroon ●Chad ●Liberia ●Mombasa ●Nairobi ●South Sudan ●Dar es Salaam ●South Africa ●Botswana ●Malawi ●Anything else you would like

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map
Prisoners of Geography p.132-140 (third part of Africa)

● DISCUSS

If you are working independently, plan a time this week to go to your teacher, show them one of your maps, and share something you are learning about a region of the world. If you are interested, you could create and share a travel log with illustrations or images that represent important ideas about the country or a travel poster created on Canva or another computer program. If working in a class, share with your classmates and teacher.

WEEK 3 ☐ 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 30

Name Games

☐ Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 15 Name Games

→ WRITE

Have you ever named any natural features, trees, or areas in your yard or around where you live? If so, write about them. If not, think about what you could name around you. Sometimes naming is tied to claiming, but this naming is just for fun and to show relationship. For example, a bench in the yard surrounded by some trees might be named Reader's Corner. Write about what you are naming and why.

→ MAP WORK

Add places or items of interest to your map.

WEEK 4 ☐ 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 31

World Geography - The Middle East

☐ Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MAP WORK

Print one blank map of the Middle East
∞ Map Link: Blank Map of the Middle East

Sketch a rough map of the Middle East.

→ READ & MAP WORK

★ STUDENT TIP

Watch this short video highlighting the "Empty Quarter."
∞ Video Link: Rub' al Khali, Saudi Arabia: Journey Into the Blazing Sands of the Empty Quarter

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

p.50-51 in your map book (optional). Locate/add to your map:

- Mediterranean Sea •Iran •Black Sea •Arabian Sea •Oman •Tigris River
- Euphrates River •Israel •Jordan •Syria •Iraq •Kuwait •Saudi Arabia
- Lebanon •Qatar •Anything else you would like

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map

Prisoners of Geography p.141-149 (part one of The Middle East)

WEEK 4 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 32

Creatures of the Mud

Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 16 Creatures of the Mud

→ WRITE

Try writing a poem about living with so much mud.

→ MAP WORK

Add places or items of interest to your map.

WEEK 5 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 33

World Geography - The Middle East Continued

Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MAP WORK

Read p.52-55 in your map book (optional). Locate/add to your map:

- Beirut •Damascus •Amman •Jerusalem •Mosul •Turkey •Istanbul
- United Arab Emirates •Baghdad •Yemen •Anything else you would like

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map

Prisoners of Geography p.150-157 (part two of The Middle East)

★ STUDENT TIP

Read the following article for a description of the three major branches of Islam.

∞ **Article Link:** The Major Branches of Islam

WEEK 5 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 34

Confluence, Bones and Oil, Angels

Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapters 17-19 Confluence, Bones and Oil, Angels

→ WRITE

Write about the issue of bison meat and natural gas, both of which don't have a way to get to market, are being wasted. Any creative solutions for then or now?

→ MAP WORK

Copy the map on p.119.

WEEK 6 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 35

World Geography - The Middle East Continued

Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MEMORY SKETCH

Sketch a rough map of Europe and see what you can fill in without looking

• DISCUSS

If you are working independently, plan a time this week to go to your teacher, show them one of your maps, and share something you are learning about a region of the world. If interested, you could create and share a travelog with

Geography: Grade 9

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Term 2

at your map.

→ MAP WORK

Locate/add to your Middle East map:

•Tel Aviv •Medina •Mecca •Somalia •Afghanistan •Turkmenistan
•Armenia •Azerbaijan •Red Sea •Caspian Sea •Anything else you would like

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map

Prisoners of Geography p.158-164 (part three of The Middle East)

illustrations or images that represent important ideas about the country or a travel poster created on Canva or another computer program. If working in a class, share with your classmates and teacher.

WEEK 6 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 36

Chronicles of the Contraption

Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 20 Chronicles of the Contraption

→ READ

∞ Article Link: Mandan, Hidatsa, and Arikara Histories of Sacagawea

→ WRITE

Write about some of the reasons that various historical stories emerge about a single person or event.

→ MAP WORK

Add places or items of interest to your map.

WEEK 7 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 37

World Geography - The Middle East Continued

Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MAP WORK

Locate/add to your map:

•Sinai Peninsula •Zagros Mountains •Elburz Mountains •Persian Gulf
•Strait of Hormuz •Tehran •Bosporus Strait •Ankara •Anything else you would like

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map

Prisoners of Geography p.165-171 (part four of The Middle East)

★ STUDENT TIP

Watch the following video to learn more about the Strait of Hormuz.

∞ Video Link: What is the Strait of Hormuz and why is it important?

WEEK 7 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 38

Forts and Villages

Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 21 Forts and Villages

→ READ

∞ Article Link: Knife River Indian Villages

∞ Article Link: Fort Clark State Historic Site

→ WRITE

Write about what interested you most from the reading and articles.

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Term 2

→ MAP WORK

Add places or items of interest to your map.

WEEK 8 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 39

World Geography - The Middle East Continued

Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MEMORY SKETCH

Sketch a rough map of Africa and see what you can fill in without looking at your map.

→ MAP WORK

Locate/add to your Middle East map:

- Anything else you would like

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map

Prisoners of Geography p.172-179 (part five of The Middle East)

WEEK 8 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 40

Aloha and Oahe!

Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 22 Aloha and Oahe!

→ WRITE

Write your thoughts about the pipeline issue.

→ MAP WORK

Add places or items of interest to your map.

WEEK 9 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 41

World Geography - India and Pakistan

Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MAP WORK

Print one blank map of India and Pakistan

∞ Map Link: Blank Map of India and Pakistan

Sketch a rough map of India and Pakistan

→ READ & MAP WORK

p.56-57 in your map book (optional). Locate/add to your map:

- India •Pakistan •Bay of Bengal •Indian Ocean •Arabian Sea •Hindu Kush Mountains •Himalayas •Baluchistan Desert •Karakoram Range •China •Burma •Bangladesh •Nepal •Bhutan •Anything else you would like

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map

Prisoners of Geography p.180-187 (part one of India and Pakistan)

★ STUDENT TIP

Watch the following short video that interviews a family that was displaced by the Partition of India.

∞ Video Link: The Partition of India

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Term 2

WEEK 9 ☐ 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 42

The Hunted

📖 Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 23 The Hunted

→ WRITE

Describe the different flora and fauna that the crew is seeing now, as well as the different scenery compared with the early days of the trip.

→ MAP WORK

Copy the map on p.163

WEEK 10 ☐ 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 43

World Geography - India and Pakistan Continued

📖 Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MAP WORK

Read p.58-59 in your map book (optional). Locate/add to your map:

●New Delhi ●Islamabad ●Thar Desert ●Ganges River ●Indus Valley
●Calcutta ●Kashmir ●Gwadar ●Sri Lanka ●Siachen Glacier ●Anything else you would like

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map
Prisoners of Geography p.188-193 (part two of India and Pakistan)

★ STUDENT TIP

Watch the following video to learn why China has an interest in partnering with Pakistan.

∞ **Video Link:** Why China Built Pakistan's Biggest Airport in the Middle of the Desert

WEEK 10 ☐ 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 44

The Good River Encounter

📖 Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 24 The Good River Encounter

→ WRITE

Write about what interested you in this reading.

→ MAP WORK

Add places or items of interest to your map.

WEEK 11 ☐ 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 45

Catch-up Week

→ CATCH UP

Finish any reading and map-making if needed.

→ MAP WORK

Practice drawing sketch maps of Africa, the Middle East, and India and Pakistan. Add as many items as you can remember. Look at your originals and see how you did. Add other items to your maps if you wish.

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Term 2

WEEK 11 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 46 Layover Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook → READ & NARRATE Chapter 25 Layover → WRITE What do you think were the reasons behind the idea of not allowing the students at the boarding school to speak their native language? → MAP WORK Add places or items of interest to your map.	
WEEK 12 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 47 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Five Months on the Missouri River	
WEEK 12 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 48 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Prisoners of Geography	

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Term 3

WEEK 1 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 49

World Geography - India and Pakistan Continued

Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MEMORY SKETCH

Sketch a rough map of the US or Canada and see what you can fill in without looking at your map. If you have been using blank maps, you may continue to do so, or you can try a rough sketch now!

→ MAP WORK

Locate/add to your India and Pakistan map:

- Anything you would like.

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map

Prisoners of Geography p.194-200 (part three of India and Pakistan)

WEEK 1 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 50

Sour Grapes

Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 26 Sour Grapes

→ WRITE

How well would you survive being on your own for days in the wilderness?

→ MAP WORK

Copy the map on p.195.

WEEK 2 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 51

World Geography - India and Pakistan Continued

Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MAP WORK

Locate/add to your map:

- Anything you would like.

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map

Prisoners of Geography p.201-205 (part four of India and Pakistan)

• DISCUSS

If you are working independently, plan a time this week to go to your teacher, show them one of your maps, and share something you are learning about a region of the world. If interested, you could create and share a travel log with illustrations or images that represent important ideas about the country or a travel poster created on Canva or another computer program. If working in a class, share with your classmates and teacher.

WEEK 2 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 52

Throwing Sand

Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 27 Throwing Sand

→ WRITE

Describe the journey at this point. What are the current challenges?

→ MAP WORK

Add places or items of interest to your map.

Geography: Grade 9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 3 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 53

World Geography - Korea and Japan

 Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MAP WORK

Print one blank map of Korea and Japan

∞ Map Link: Blank Map of Korea and Japan

Sketch a rough map of Korea and Japan.

→ READ & MAP WORK

p.60-61 in your map book (optional). Locate/add to your map:

- North Korea •South Korea •Japan •Tokyo •Pyongyang •Yalu River
- Hamhung Mountains •Seoul •Sea of Japan •Pacific Ocean •Yellow Sea
- East China Sea •Anything else you would like

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map

Prisoners of Geography p.207-215 (part one of Korea and Japan)

★ STUDENT TIP

You may continue mapping using the same method or try a new one! The purpose is to help you remember and think about the geography of the country.

If time permits, read the following article to better understand the United States alliance with South Korea.

∞ **Article Link:** U.S.- South Korea Alliance: Background and Issues for Congress

WEEK 3 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 54

Channeling Floyd

 Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 28 Channeling Floyd

→ WRITE

Thoughts on the costs of dying these days compared to the past?

→ MAP WORK

Add places or items of interest to your map.

WEEK 4 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 55

World Geography - Korea and Japan Continued

 Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MAP WORK

Read p.62-63 in your map book (optional). Locate/add to your map:

- Dokdo Islands or Takeshima Islands •Honshu •Korea Strait •Hiroshima
- Nagasaki •Ryukyu Islands •Kuril Islands •Hokkaido •China •Anything else you would like

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map

Prisoners of Geography p.216-222 (part two of Korea and Japan)

★ STUDENT TIP

Remember to label what you reasonably want to recall.

The following short video provides additional insight as to why North and South Korea are divided.

∞ **Video Link:** Why are North and South Korea Divided?

WEEK 4 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 56

Fish Stories

 Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 29 Fish Stories

→ WRITE

Why do you suppose carp is considered a delicacy in other parts of the

Geography: Grade 9

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Term 3

world but not here?

→ MAP WORK

Add places or items of interest to your map.

WEEK 5 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 57

World Geography

Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

Korea and Japan Continued

→ MEMORY SKETCH

Sketch a rough map of India and Pakistan and see what you can fill in without looking at your map.

→ MAP WORK

Locate/add to your Korea and Japan map:

- Anything you would like.

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map

Prisoners of Geography p.223-227 (part three of Korea and Japan)

• DISCUSS

If you are working independently, plan a time this week to go to your teacher, show them one of your maps, and share something you are learning about a region of the world. If interested, you could create and share a travel log with illustrations or images that represent important ideas about the country or a travel poster created on Canva or another computer program. If working in a class, share with your classmates and teacher.

WEEK 5 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 58

Water World

Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 30 Water World

→ WRITE

Elpel and the group eat paw paws. Do these grow in your area? What regional fruits and vegetables grow in your area? You might need to do some research to find out.

→ MAP WORK

Add places or items of interest to your map.

WEEK 6 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 59

World Geography - Latin America

Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MAP WORK

Print one blank map of Latin America

∞ Map Link: Blank Map of Latin America

Sketch a rough map of Latin America.

→ READ & MAP WORK

p.64-65 in your map book (optional). Locate/add to your map:

•Peru •Argentina •Mexico •Brazil •Chile •Tierra del Fuego •Cape Horn
•Pacific Ocean •Atlantic Ocean •Gulf of Mexico •Caribbean Sea •Andes Mountains •Ecuador •Colombia •Venezuela •Amazon River •French Guiana •Anything else you would like

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map

Prisoners of Geography p.229-238 (part one of Latin America)

Geography: Grade 9

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Term 3

WEEK 6 ☐ 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 60

Cold Front

☐ Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 31 Cold Front

→ WRITE

Why would it be important to read accounts of wars from both the winner and the loser's perspective?

→ MAP WORK

Copy the map on p.232.

WEEK 7 ☐ 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 61

World Geography - Latin America Continued

☐ Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MAP WORK

Read p.66-67 in your map book (optional). Locate/add to your map:

•Guatemala •Belize •Nicaragua •Panamá •Sierra Madres •Mexico City
•Uruguay •Paraguay •Anything else you would like

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map
Prisoners of Geography p.239-245 (part two of Latin America)

WEEK 7 ☐ 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 62

Sawyers

☐ Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 32 Sawyers

→ READ

∞ Article Link: Missouri River

→ WRITE

The Army Corps of Engineers straightened and narrowed the Missouri in the 20th century to improve navigation and prevent floods. What values drive the decision to tame a wild river? Who benefits and who bears the costs? What about the pros and cons of channelization?

→ MAP WORK

Add places or items of interest to your map.

WEEK 8 ☐ 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 63

World Geography - Latin America Continued

☐ Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MAP WORK

Read p.68-69 in your map book (optional). Locate/add to your map:

•Rio de Janeiro •Brasília •Rio de la Plata region •Falkland Islands or Las Malvinas •Buenos Aires •Patagonia •Anything else you would like

Geography: Grade 9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map
Prisoners of Geography p.246-253 (part three of Latin America)

WEEK 8 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 64

Taste of Freedom

Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 33 Taste of Freedom

→ WRITE

Would you enjoy a historic trip like this for this long? Why or why not?

→ MAP WORK

Add places or items of interest to your map.

WEEK 9 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 65

World Geography - The Arctic

Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MAP WORK

Print one blank map of the Arctic
∞ Map Link: Blank Map of the Arctic
Sketch a rough map of the Arctic.

→ READ & MAP WORK

p.70-73 in your map book (optional). Locate/add to your map:

- Russia •Alaska •Canada •Arctic Ocean •Finland •Iceland •Greenland
- Norway •Sweden •North Pole •King William Island •Bering Strait
- Anything else you would like

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map
Prisoners of Geography p.254-262 (part one of The Arctic)

★ STUDENT TIP

Spend a few minutes exploring the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration website. Review the report card given to the Arctic.

∞ Article Link: Report Card 2025 - NOAA Arctic

WEEK 9 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 66

A River Relieved

Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 34 A River Relieved

→ WRITE

Thoughts about the litter problem? What are practical ways that we can help?

→ MAP WORK

Add places or items of interest to your map.

WEEK 10 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 67

World Geography - The Arctic Continued

Materials: Prisoners of Geography, map book (optional)

→ MAP WORK

Read p.74-76 in your map book (optional). Locate/add to your map:

Geography: Grade 9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

- Lomonosov Ridge •Barents Sea •Gakkel Ridge •Svalbard Islands
- Northwest Passage •Northern Sea Route •Norwegian Sea •Nares Strait
- Ellesmere Island •Anything else you would like

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently, referencing your map
Prisoners of Geography p.263-271 (part two of The Arctic)

WEEK 10 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 68

Advance to St. Charles

Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 35 Advance to St. Charles

→ WRITE

Thoughts on funding adventures?

→ MAP WORK

Add places or items of interest to your map.

WEEK 11 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 69

World Geography - Conclusion

Materials: Prisoners of Geography

→ CATCH UP

Finish any reading and map-making if needed.

→ READ & NARRATE

Read aloud or silently
Prisoners of Geography p.273-277 (Conclusion)

→ MEMORY SKETCH

Practice drawing sketch maps of Korea and Japan, and Latin America.
Add as many items as you can remember. Look at your originals and see how you did.

• DISCUSS

If you are working independently, plan a time this week to go to your teacher, show them one of your maps, and share something you are learning about a region of the world. If interested, you could create and share a travelog with illustrations or images that represent important ideas about the country or a travel poster created on Canva or another computer program. If working in a class, share with your classmates and teacher.

WEEK 11 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 70

Gateway

Materials: Five Months on the Missouri River, notebook

→ READ & NARRATE

Chapter 36 Gateway

→ WRITE

How would you imagine ending a 5-month paddling trip down the Missouri River? What sort of celebration would you plan?

→ MAP WORK

Add places or items of interest to your map.

WEEK 12 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 71

World Geography

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Geography: Grade 9

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Term 3	
Questions will come from: Prisoners of Geography	
WEEK 12 30m Geography: Grade 9 - Lesson 72 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Five Months on the Missouri River	

Geography: Grade 9

Examination

Term 1

· Prisoners of Geography: Sketch a map with as many details as you can of Russia, China, the US, Canada, or Europe. Explain how the geography of the area shown on your map helps us understand some of the historical, political, economic, or other issues of the area.

· Historical Geography

• Five Months on the Missouri River: Write about the aspects of the trip down the Missouri River so far that have stood out to you. What have you seen? What thoughts have come to mind about what it must have been like for Lewis and Clark and crew to travel this same path?

Term 2

· Prisoners of Geography: Sketch a map with as many details as you can of Africa, the Middle East, or India and Pakistan. Explain how the geography of the area shown on your map helps us understand some of the historical, political, economic, or other issues of the area.

· Historical Geography

• Five Months on the Missouri River: Write about the aspects of this last term of the trip. What have you seen? What thoughts have come to mind about what it must have been like for Lewis and Clark and crew to travel this same path? What has been of interest to you?

Term 3

· Prisoners of Geography: Sketch a map with as many details as you can of Korea and Japan, Latin America, or the Arctic. Explain how the geography of the area shown on your map helps us understand some of the historical, political, economic, or other issues of the area.

· Historical Geography

• Five Months on the Missouri River: Write about the aspects of this last term of the trip. What have you seen? What thoughts have come to mind about what it must have been like for Lewis and Clark and crew to travel this same path? What has been of interest to you?